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OAKLAND COMMUNITY SCHOOL OPENS FIFTH YEAR



(Oakland, Calif.) - America's public schools began the 1975-76 school year in chaos and violence. In Boston, Massachusetts, and Louisville, Kentucky, clashes erupted between police and White racists opposed to forced school busing (see article, page 7). Meanwhile, in cities from Berkeley, California, to New York City, teachers' strikes have left one out of 22 public school children out of school. Amidst the turbulence in the public school system is a distinct, refreshing contrast, indeed, an example of what education should be all about — the highly respected Oakland Community School, which peacefully began its fifth year of innovative education for Black and poor youth on September 8.

The tuition-free, fully accredited School, (formerly the Intercommunal Youth Institute), located at 6118 E. 14th Street in East Oakland, has a current enrollment of 120 children between the ages of two and one-half and 11. The children are placed in eight ungraded groups according to their skills and abilities. The eighth group is new this year and has been added to better serve the diverse educational needs of the children.

The staff of the Oakland Community School, headed by its dedicated director, Ms. Ericka Huggins, has worked diligently to develop an exciting, model educational curriculum geared toward the creation of a learning atmosphere absent of the sterile and abstract techniques

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Students of the Oakland Community School deeply involved in a science class. The School began its fifth year on September 8, providing Black and poor youth with an innovative and creative educational program which is unparalleled in the stagnant, racist public school system.

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